

closure-evidence

BOB-136 — closure evidence

Item: Closure seam does not bind: 4 tracker rows found stale in one sweep, and workable-items diff is blind to body_md drift **Type:** Task · **Closed:** 2026-08-21 · **HEAD at capture:** 57e20c0

Every acceptance clause below was verified by INVOCATION, not by reading source or usage text (§11.4.226 — a runtime-layer claim needs runtime-class evidence).

(a) The flagless diff no longer returns a clean verdict without reading Markdown

```
$ workable-items diff --db docs/workable_items.db
exit=1
diff: at least one of --issues / --fixed is required – refusing to
report a
DB-vs-Markdown verdict without reading any Markdown (pass --db-
only to run
just the DB-internal integrity checks)
```

The explicit escape says what it did NOT do, rather than implying a comparison:

```
$ workable-items diff --db docs/workable_items.db --db-only
diff: DB-internal checks passed – 164 item(s) inspected; no
Markdown compared (--db-only)
```

CONTROL NEEDLE (§11.4.201(7)(b)) — the refusal above is only evidence if the binary still works on the same DB when given the flags. It does:

```
$ workable-items diff --db docs/workable_items.db --issues docs/
Issues.md --fixed docs/Fixed.md
diff: DB and Markdown are in sync (compared 164 Markdown item(s))
```

```
against 164 DB item(s);
read docs/Issues.md, docs/Fixed.md)
```

Without that third line the `exit=1` above would be indistinguishable from a broken binary refusing everything.

(b) No caller uses the flagless form

```
CHECK B flagless-diff callers ..... PASS (0 callers of the false-
null form)
```

(c) A sweep flags non-terminal rows whose id appears in a merged commit

Wired as pre-build invariant 49, verified at three layers:

- SOURCE — `pre_build_verification.sh:1818` invokes the gate script
- ARTIFACT — the driver advertises 49/49 (was 48 before this wiring)
- RUNTIME — the gate executes:

```
structural commit<->item links .. 220
control needle (§11.4.201(7)(b)) . PASS (4/4 known links seen)
CHECK A closure seam ..... PASS (0 stale rows, 0
untracked ids)
```

The needle matters for the same reason as in (a): CHECK A's zero is only meaningful because the instrument was proven able to see 4/4 known links through the same path. A blind sweep and a clean repo both report zero.

The two blockers the body's last Progress line named are drained

That line read: *"20 stale rows and 2 untracked ids remain to drain, and the gate is not wired into `pre_build_verification.sh`".* All three conditions are now false. `N_UNTRK > 0` fails the gate (`check_cm_closure_seam_binds.sh:617`), so CHECK A PASS entails untracked ids are zero as well as stale rows — a fact the PASS message did not previously state, and which misled a reader of this very closure before it was corrected to report both counts.

Honest boundary (§11.4.6) — what this does NOT claim

The seam only sees work that DECLARES its id in a commit message. A fix landing under a message naming no item stays invisible to it. That is BOB-136's own second defect, and acceptance clause (d) scoped it out explicitly: *"this does not claim to prevent all drift."* Closing this item does not close that gap.

Reproduce

```
bash scripts/pre_build/check_cm_closure_seam_binds.sh
bash tests/pre_build/test_check_cm_closure_seam_binds.sh    #
30/30
```